

SHIRA KATES

AI-FORWARD UX LEADERSHIP · PRODUCT STRATEGY ·
ENTERPRISE & AGENTIC UX

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Senior UX and AI strategy leader with 20+ years shaping products from 0 to 1 across enterprise, platform, and AI-powered experiences. Most recently at Google, where I built and led AppSheet's multidisciplinary UX team through a period of **4x MAU growth**, establishing UX as a trusted strategic partner at the intersection of product vision, engineering, and generative AI. Deep craft in human-AI interaction design, vision definition, cross-functional alignment, and team development, with a strong point of view on making AI genuinely useful for real users.

EXPERIENCE

Head of UX, AppSheet 2022 – 2026
Google, AppSheet & Cloud AI, San Diego CA

- 4x MAU growth
- 40%+ YoY growth
- 80M Vertex AI tokens
- 400% usage increase Jul–Oct 2025
- 2,000+ AI-built apps
- 1,500 Gemini tasks/day
- 95% customer satisfaction

- Led AppSheet's multidisciplinary UX team** (design, research, writing) across creator, app-user, admin, and database surfaces; MAU nearly quadrupled with 40%+ sustained YoY growth since joining.
- Directed UX for Gemini-assisted app creation** and Visual First Editor Phase 2, contributing to +8.8% app creator success, +12% uplift in paid Workspace users, and +1.5% 14-day retention in enterprise; drove 2,000+ active apps built with AI and 80M Vertex AI tokens consumed in a single month.
- Achieved 400% increase in AI feature usage** (Jul–Oct 2025) across 300+ unique apps and 1,500 Gemini AI tasks per day, reflecting user trust in AI-augmented workflows.
- Led UX for Chat Apps integration with Workspace**, reducing setup from 15 steps/30 minutes to 1 minute; 1,800+ monthly deployments, 1,100+ customer domains in the first month, 10,800 annual developer hours saved. **2023 H2 Cloud Tech Impact Award.**
- Led UX for AppSheet Database**, contributing to +38% 28-day MAU and +39% editor MAU YoY. **Cloud Tech Impact Award.**
- Orchestrated UX for the Admin Console and license management** experience; onboarded 1,000+ new enterprise admins, helped unlock the Vertiv 27K-license deal, and enabled monetization for 1M+ users.
- Initiated and led a research-backed 3-year UX/product vision**, aligning VP-level leadership on product pillars and seeding generative AI programs including AI Verbs (200% usage increase, 2M+ AI tokens across 70+ apps) and Gemini App Creation.
- Presented long-term AI/UX strategy to Thomas Kurian (Google Cloud CEO)**; work seeded the first generative AI experiences shipped from Google Cloud.
- Defined the Evolved Agents / Frontline Worker Agent vision**, a novel approach combining apps and agents for dynamic, adaptive, hands-free enterprise UX; now influencing Cloud AI VP-level strategy, PM roadmaps, and PRDs.
- Founded AppSheet's EQ Week**, a bi-yearly hackathon mobilizing 35+ participants across 18 projects; 7 advanced to roadmap, AI Verbs debuted at Cloud NEXT, 6 features shipped to date.

CORE EXPERTISE

- AI TOOLS & PLATFORMS**
- Gemini Agent Designer
 - Google AI Studio
 - VoiceFlow
 - Claude / Anthropic
 - ChatGPT / OpenAI
 - Figma AI
 - Canva AI
 - Notion AI
 - NotebookLM
 - GitHub Copilot
 - Vibe Coding
 - Claude CoWork

- AI & PRODUCT STRATEGY**
- Generative AI / GenAI
 - Agentic UX
 - Human-AI Interaction
 - LLM Product Design
 - AI Vision & Roadmap
 - 0 to 1 Product Dev

- UX PRACTICE**
- Enterprise UX
 - UX Research
 - Design Systems
 - UX Writing
 - Conversational Design
 - Accessibility
 - CUJ & UX Metrics

- LEADERSHIP & PROCESS**
- Cross-functional Alignment
 - Executive Storytelling
 - OKR Planning
 - Design Sprints
 - Workshop Facilitation
 - Stakeholder Management
 - Team Development
 - Participatory Co-design

RECOGNITION

- Cloud Tech Impact Award, Chat Apps (2023 H2)
- Cloud Tech Impact Award, AppSheet Database (2023)
- AI Verbs debut at Cloud NEXT (Hackathon)
- US Patent: Mobile Ad Campaign Management (2015)
- Speaker: Disruptive AI-UX Summit, SDXD, UCSD Design
- Secured Cloud NEXT & I/O slots for direct reports

- / **Established the CUJ baseline program** for measuring critical user journeys; created XFN alignment on UX health metrics now referenced in planning cycles.
- / **Explored AppSheet x Agentspace integration** (apps as tools inside agents); concepts implemented and referenced in product documentation and PRDs.
- / **Managed and developed a high-performing team;** strategic hires including Staff Designer and conversational design specialist; one direct promoted to L6, multiple gained speaking roles at Cloud NEXT and I/O. 2025 manager survey: Deliver Results 4.58, Develop People 4.77, Build Community 4.93 out of 5.

UX Consultant, Assistive AI Aug 2021 – May 2022
Course Hero · Freelance

Established conversational AI design practice and standards for an AI-powered homework help product. Created UX writing guidelines, conversational AI interaction patterns, and design system components for human-AI interaction.

Chief Design Officer 2019 – 2022
CivicActions

Hired as Content Designer; promoted to CDO within a year. Led UX, content strategy, and design systems for government digital transformation and public sector service design. Won a \$25M federal contract as design lead.

Director, Ad Platform Programmatic Intelligence UX 2014 – 2017
Yahoo / BrightRoll

Led UX for ad platform and programmatic intelligence products through BrightRoll's \$640M acquisition by Yahoo. Built the UX practice from the ground up across data, analytics, and platform surfaces.

Senior Content Designer, Knowledge UX 2013 – 2014
Google (Maps, Search, Identity)

Content design for launched feature experiments including Explore Around You. Led the content audit of the entire Google Maps experience, improving UX for billions of users.

Content Systems Expert 2012 – 2013
Accenture Interactive

Content systems and UX strategy for enterprise clients including Meta, HP, and Microsoft.

CERTIFICATIONS & COMMUNITY

- Hudson Executive Coaching Certification (2025)
- G2G Coach & gMentor, Google
- UCSD Design Lab, mentor & judge
- Grace Hopper Celebration, equity advocate
- A11y partnerships, Chrome Accessibility

EDUCATION

MBA, Design Strategy
California College of the Arts

BA, English Literature
Skidmore College